

Officer Rusk Incident and Use-of-Force Report

Agency: Alder Creek Police Department **Event:** ACPD-2025-0203-194211-WC **Author:** Officer Nolan Rusk, unit 214 **Event date:** February 3, 2025 **Report completed:** February 4, 2025 **Civil exhibit lodged:** November 21, 2025

This fictional report records Rusk's account of a welfare-check seizure and one conducted-energy drive-stun cycle. It was written after Rusk reviewed his preliminary notes and the device activation display, but before civil depositions. Statements about movements during the obstructed camera interval are Rusk's observations and are disputed by Mara Ellison. The report is not a judicial finding.

At 19:47, Dispatcher Lena Cho assigned Officer Priya Vega and me to Larkspur Court Apartments, 1844 Holloway Road. The caller, Iris Ellison, requested a welfare check for her sister Mara. Dispatch reported a medication or mental-health concern, no known weapon, no assault, and no criminal complaint. I acknowledged that information. I understood our objective was to assess safety and obtain medical or crisis assistance if needed.

I arrived at 19:52, activated or confirmed my body camera was active, and walked toward Building C. Fixed lights illuminated the exterior breezeway. I saw Ellison seated by apartment C-12. Her hands were visible and empty at my first view.

Contact before physical restraint

I identified myself and asked Ellison to confirm her name. She answered but told me to leave. I explained that her sister was concerned and that we needed to determine whether she was safe. Ellison appeared distressed and shifted between looking at me, the stair opening, and items near the apartment door. I did not see a weapon. She did not threaten me verbally or approach me at that stage.

Officer Vega arrived and remained several steps behind and to my left. I asked Ellison to keep her hands where I could see them and to stand slowly so we could speak away from the stair edge. She questioned the instruction and began changing her seated position. I believed she might leave the breezeway or move unpredictably, though she had not yet attempted to run.

At approximately 19:53:02, I took control of Ellison's left wrist. I agree that this restraint began a seizure. I used a wrist control rather than handcuffs or the energy device at first. Ellison immediately pulled the arm toward her torso and rotated away. I told her to stop pulling and give me her other hand.

My camera was mounted on the center of my outer uniform. As the distance closed, my arm, Ellison's coat, and the breezeway structure moved across its field. I did not intentionally cover the lens. I could see more with my eyes than the chest camera recorded, although my attention was divided by the physical contact.

Rusk's account of the obstructed interval

From approximately 19:53:08 forward, Ellison actively twisted against the hold. In my perception she turned into me, struck my forearm with her free arm or hand, and moved that hand toward the equipment side of my duty belt. I felt contact on the forearm and saw movement toward the belt area at close distance. I believed she might obtain my conducted-energy weapon, sidearm, or another tool.

I said "stop pulling." Ellison said, "you're hurting me." I continued directing her to show or give me her free hand. I did not interpret her words alone as a threat. My safety assessment arose from the physical movement I perceived. I cannot identify a camera frame that visibly confirms the forearm strike or belt reach because the image was obstructed.

Ellison did not display a weapon, and I did not see an object in her hands. My concern was access to equipment during the struggle, not a weapon she brought to the call. I also did not see her attempt to descend the stairs during the closest contact.

Officer Vega was moving closer. I could not wait for a complete repositioning because I perceived the hand near my equipment. I decided to use a single drive-stun cycle to interrupt the movement while directing Ellison down. Ellison later denied striking or reaching and characterized her movement as recoil from wrist pain. That is not my recollection.

Conducted-energy activation and takedown

At approximately 19:53:16, I placed the conducted-energy weapon against Ellison through or adjacent to her outer clothing and initiated drive-stun operation. The device's event log later showed one five-second trigger activation ending around 19:53:21. I did not deploy probes. I gave no second cycle. I maintained control of her wrist and used body positioning to take her toward the floor while the cycle ran.

Ellison cried out and continued moving during part of the descent. My camera image remained obstructed. When the view cleared at approximately 19:53:22, Ellison was down in the breezeway. Officer Vega arrived at hand level and assisted. We directed Ellison to place her hands behind her. The cuffs were secured at approximately 19:53:37. I checked spacing and double-locked them after control was established.

I stopped force once the hands were secured. I did not kick, punch, knee-strike, or apply another electronic cycle. No weapon was recovered from Ellison or the immediate area. Her phone and keys were accounted for near the doorway.

Because the contact involved a person in reported crisis, we reduced simultaneous commands after handcuffing. Vega spoke with Ellison while I advised dispatch of the use of force and requested medical response. I did not arrest or cite Ellison. The protective objective continued through medical evaluation and transport.

Medical response and notifications

Ellison complained that her wrist hurt, her shoulder had been pulled, and the contact sites burned. I visually observed a superficial wrist abrasion and two small reddened contact areas. I did not diagnose their severity. Paramedic Mateo Cole arrived, evaluated Ellison, and recommended or arranged transport to Alder Creek Regional Medical Center. Ellison remained handcuffed only as long as officers and medical personnel considered necessary for scene control; the medical record separately states the timing and treatment.

I notified Lieutenant Marcus Hale because department policy requires supervisory review of conducted-energy use. I identified the device, reported one drive-stun cycle, and submitted it for event-log download. I uploaded my body-camera recording under the incident number. I did not edit the file or select the obstruction. Sergeant Lila Grant later handled the evidence export for civil discovery.

The use-of-force form asked whether the person was armed, injured, arrested, or transported. I recorded: no weapon observed or recovered; possible superficial contact and wrist or shoulder injury; no criminal arrest; medical transport. I classified resistance as active because of my reported twisting, forearm strike, and equipment reach. That classification reflects my account and is disputed.

I had no visible injury requiring treatment. I noted transient forearm tenderness but did not request photographs or medical care. The absence of documented officer injury does not alter what I report perceiving, though it is part of the complete record.

Report certification and limitations

I certify that this report states my recollection as recorded on February 4, 2025. The incident times were later refined from synchronized system records. Where a refined time differs by a few seconds from my initial handwritten notes, the system time controls the chronology used in this exhibit. The critical obstruction is fixed at 19:53:08 through 19:53:22, and the one energy cycle at approximately 19:53:16 through 19:53:21.

I understand that my body camera does not show Ellison's hands during the decisive interval and that Vega's camera does not provide a reliable hand view. The audible commands, Ellison's cry, and movement noise do not independently prove my reported strike or reach. My testimony supplies those disputed observations. I do not assert that the video visibly or conclusively contradicts Ellison's account.

This narrative does not offer a legal opinion concerning excessive force or qualified immunity. It describes the circumstances I say informed my decision. Lawyers and courts must apply the governing law under the applicable procedural standard. Medical personnel determine clinical findings, and the records unit authenticates exported media.

I reviewed the report for accuracy after it was transcribed into the fictional case file. No real officer, department, resident, or apartment location is represented. The electronic signature denotes completion within the invented agency system and nothing more.